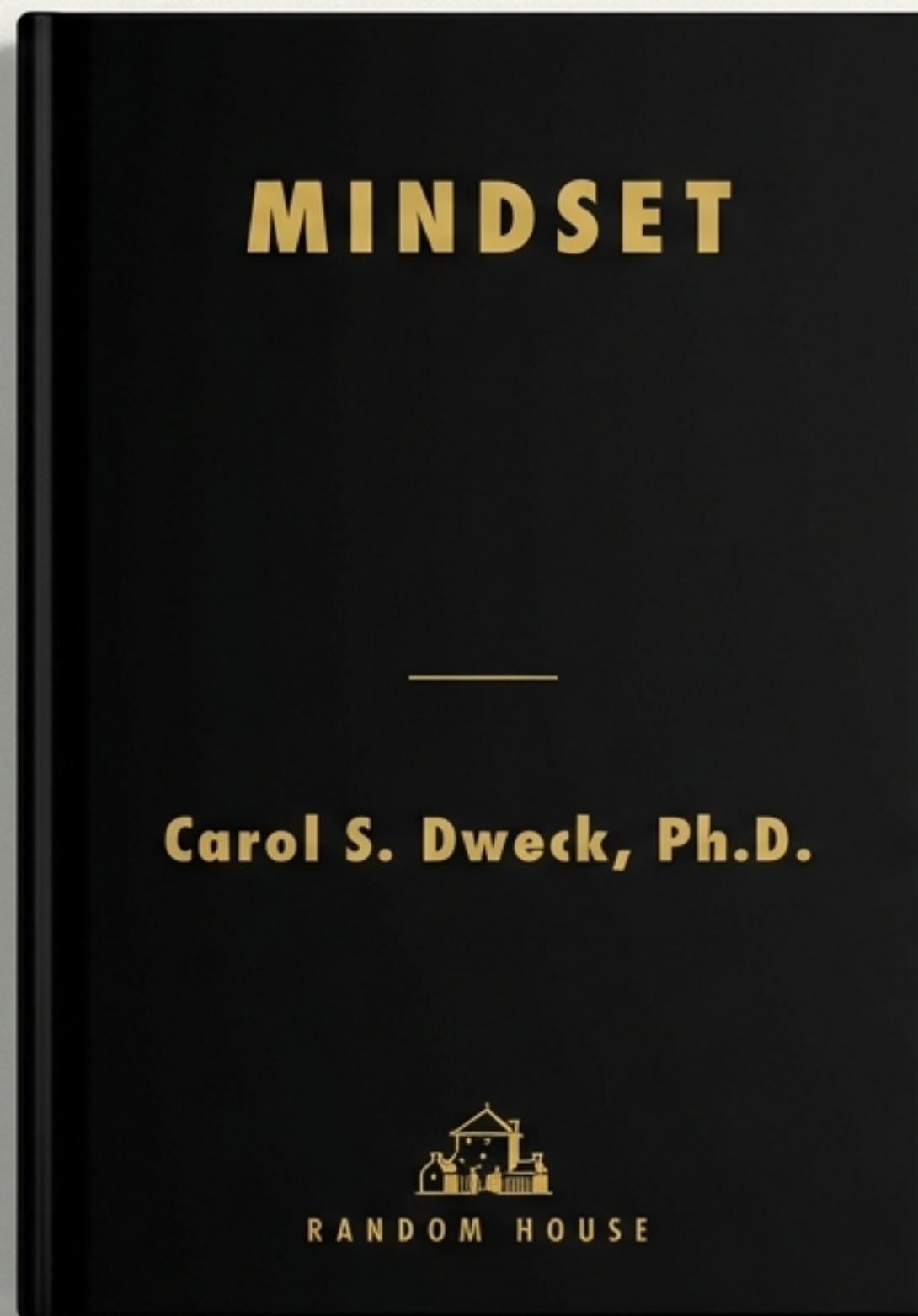




MINDSET: The New Psychology of Success

Based on the research of Carol S. Dweck, Ph.D.



A reading deck on how beliefs shape our lives.

We misunderstood the story of the Tortoise and the Hare.

We were taught that “slow and steady wins the race.” But nobody actually wanted to be the tortoise. We wanted to be the hare, just a less foolish one.

The Misconception:

The story reinforced a dangerous “either-or” belief: Either you have ability (the Hare) or you have to expend effort (the Tortoise).

The Hidden Truth:

This binary creates the belief that effort is only for those who lack talent. This is the seed of the Fixed Mindset.



Which world do you live in?

Read the statements below. Do you mostly agree or disagree?

The Intelligence Audit

1. Your intelligence is something very basic about you that you can't change very much.	☐ Agree ☐ Disagree
2. You can learn new things, but you can't really change how intelligent you are.	☐ Agree ☐ Disagree

The Personality Audit

1. You are a certain kind of person, and there is not much that can be done to really change that.	☐ Agree ☐ Disagree
2. You can do things differently, but the important parts of who you are can't really be changed.	☐ Agree ☐ Disagree

The Verdict: If you agreed with these, you are leaning toward a Fixed Mindset.
If you disagreed, you lean toward a Growth Mindset.

The Tale of Two Worlds

Fixed Mindset: Carved in Stone

- **Belief:** Intelligence and personality are static traits.
- **Goal:** You must prove you have a healthy dose of these traits.
- **The Urgency:** Every situation is a test. “Will I look smart or dumb? Will I be accepted or rejected?”

Growth Mindset: Cultivated through Effort

- **Belief:** The hand you’re dealt is just the starting point.
- **Goal:** To stretch and develop yourself.
- **The Perspective:** Human qualities can be cultivated through effort and help from others.

“In one world, failure is about having a setback...
In the other world, failure is about not growing.”

Effort: Risking the Ego vs. Seizing the Chance

Case Study: The University of Hong Kong English Course

The Fixed Mindset Reaction

- **Action:** Refused the remedial course.
- **Reasoning:** To take the course is to admit a deficiency. They preferred to put their college career at risk rather than look "dumb" in the short term.

The Growth Mindset Reaction

- **Action:** Said an emphatic "Yes".
- **Reasoning:** Success is about learning. If you are not good at English, you take a course.

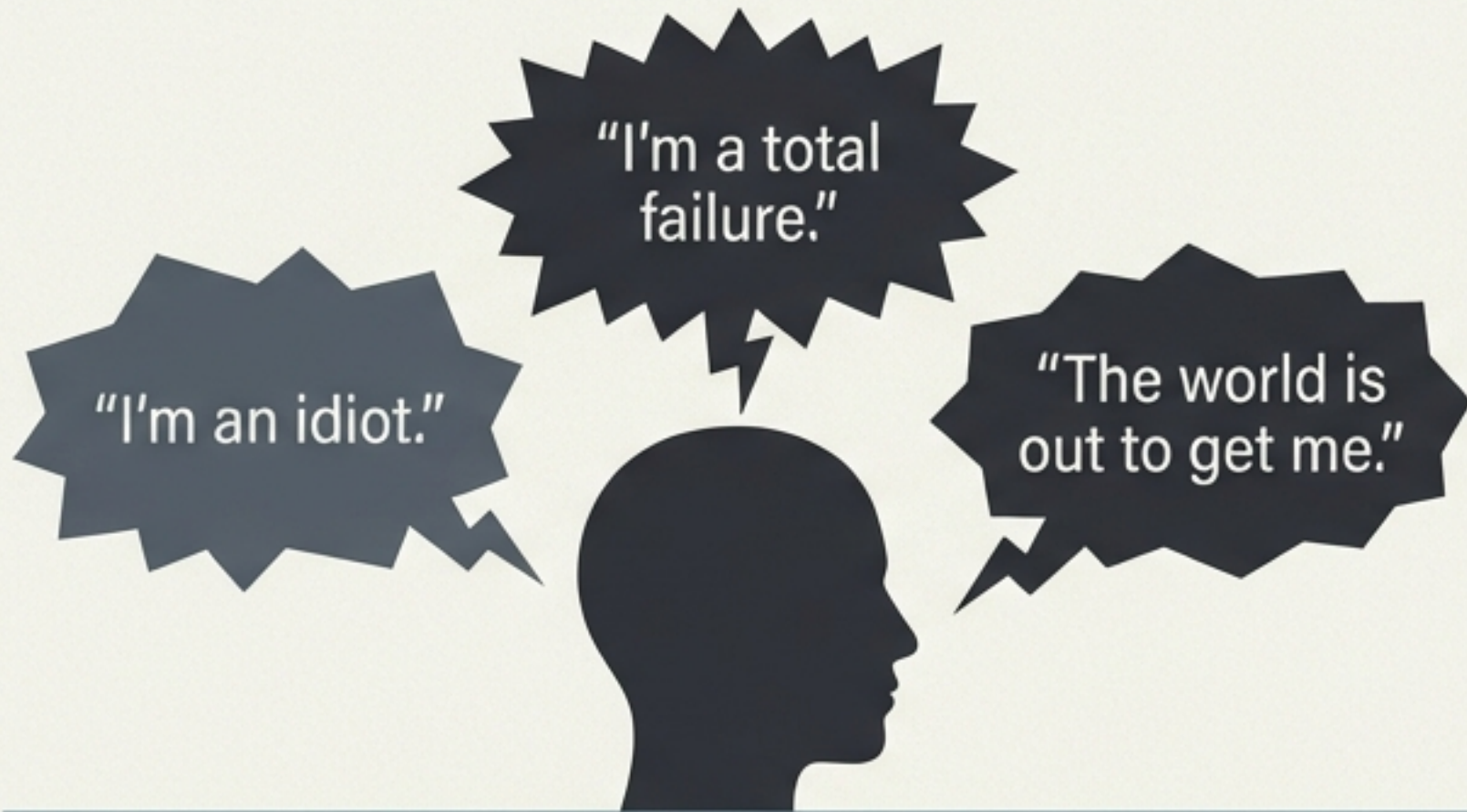


The Takeaway: In the Fixed Mindset, effort is a sign of weakness.

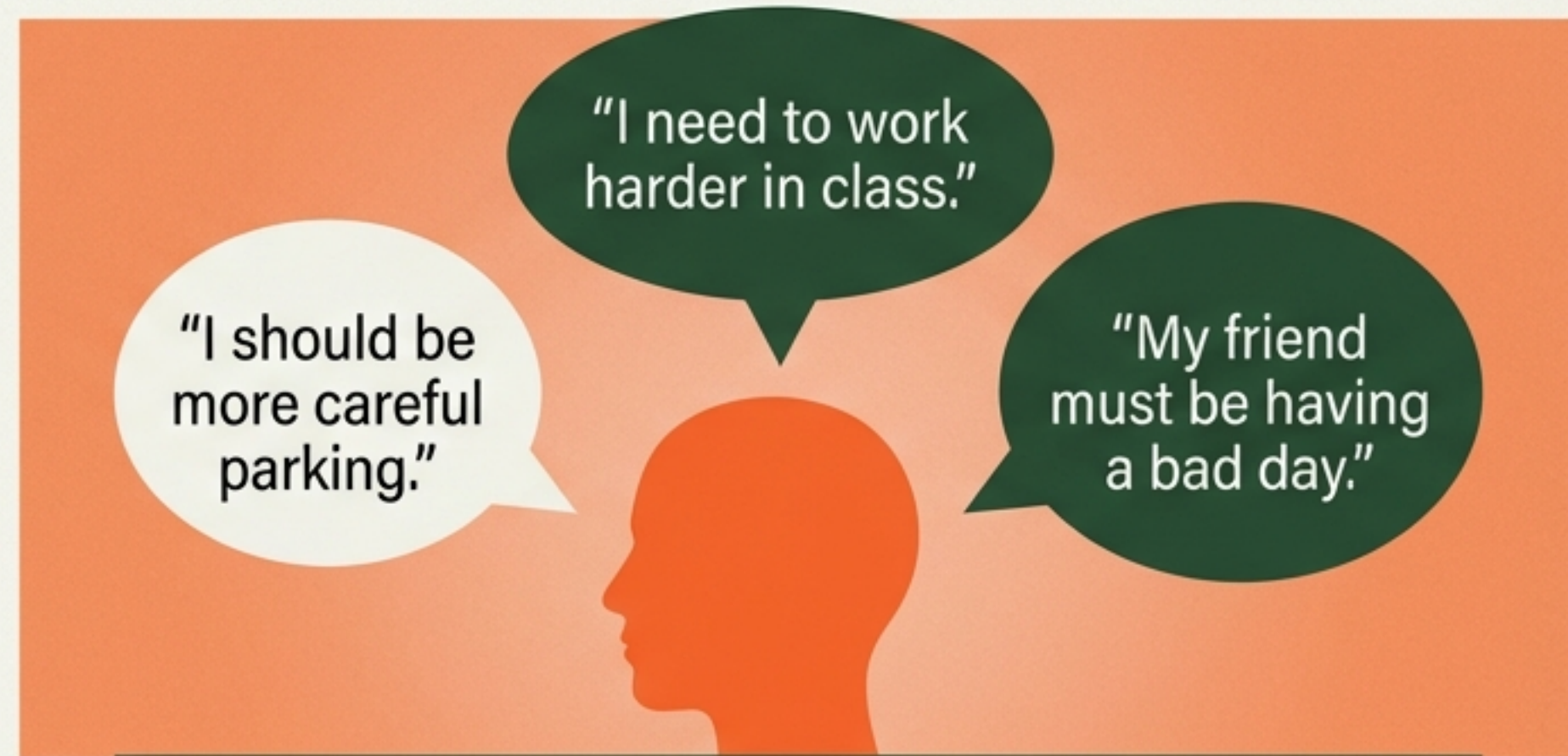
In the Growth Mindset, **effort is the vehicle for becoming smarter.**

Anatomy of a Bad Day

The Scenario: You get a C+ on a midterm. You get a parking ticket. You call a friend to vent, and they brush you off.



Action: Get drunk, stay in bed, eat chocolate, or pick a fight.



Action: Study for the next test, pay the ticket, call the friend back.

When do you feel smart?

The 4-Year-Old Puzzle Experiment



Sticks to the safe, easy puzzle.

Smart = When I finish fast
and it's perfect.



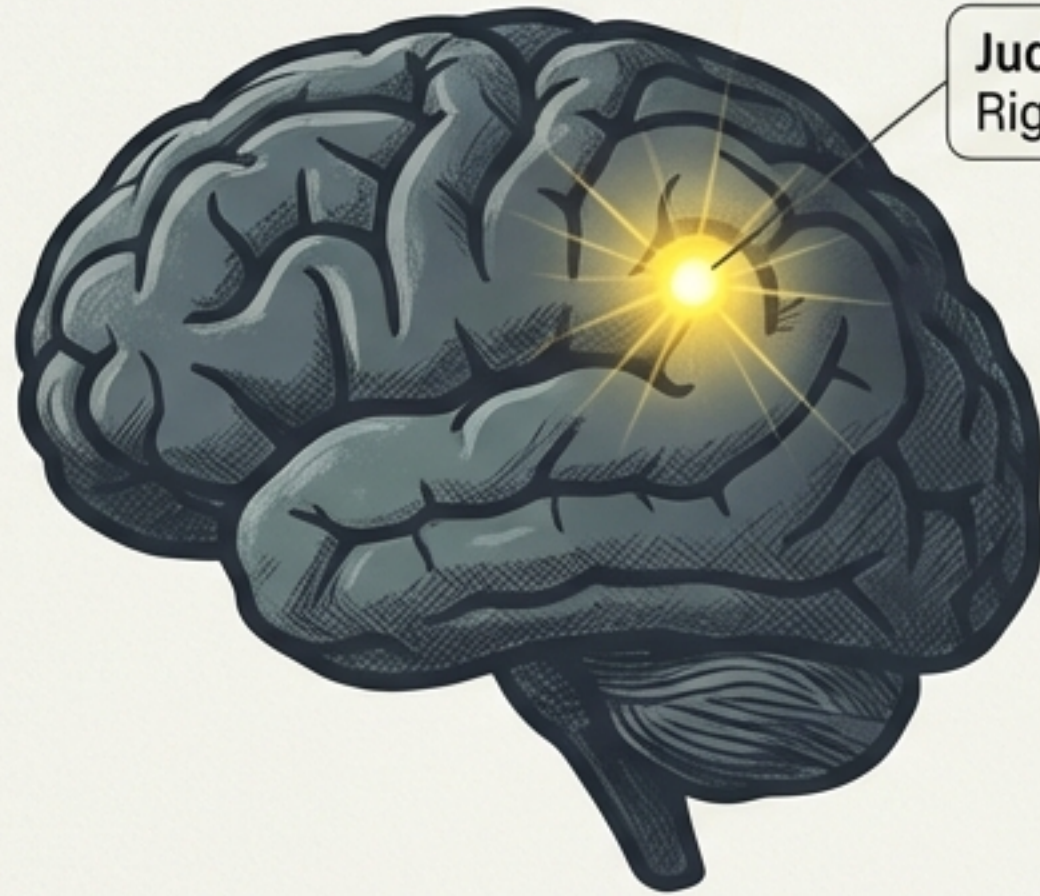
Chooses the hard one.

Smart = When I try really hard and
do something I couldn't do before.

Editorial Psychology

Brain Waves Tell the Story

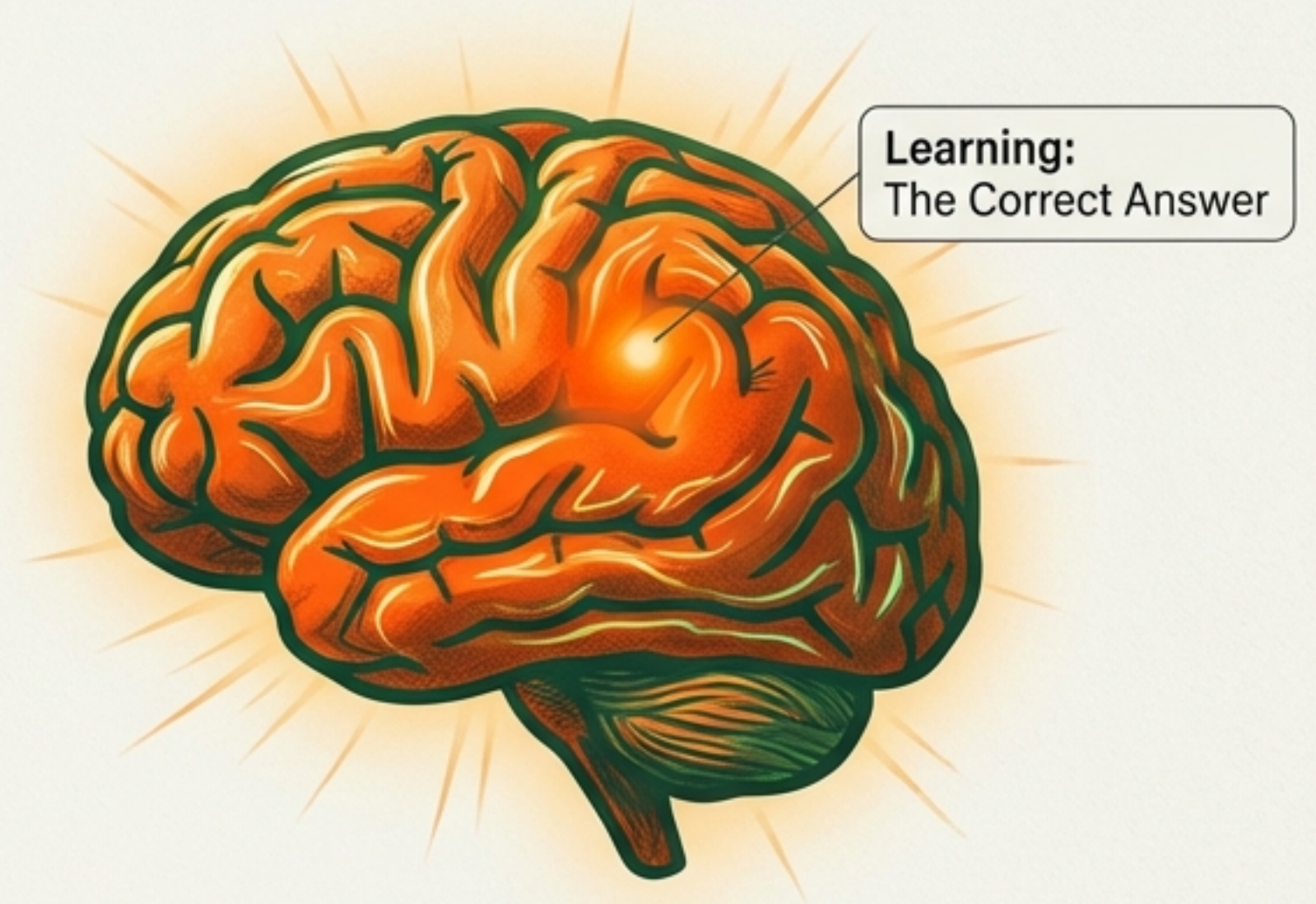
Columbia University Brain Wave Study



Judgment:
Right or Wrong

Fixed Mindset

Brain goes dark when presented with the correct answer or learning information. They are only interested in judgment.



Learning:
The Correct Answer

Growth Mindset

Brain lights up for information that could help them learn. Learning is the priority.

The Talent Myth in the Arena

John McEnroe (Fixed Mindset)



Believed talent was everything. Did not love to learn.

The “Sawdust” Incident: Blamed the ground (like “rat poison”) for a loss.

Pattern: It was too cold, too hot, or the sawdust was wrong. It was never his fault.

Michael Jordan (Growth Mindset)



“Superman” was actually the hardest worker.

Reaction to failure: “I was shocked with the level of intensity... I’m a human being like everyone else.”

Embraced struggle and growth over “natural” superiority.

The Fixed Mindset forces you to blame the world to protect your “talent” identity.

CEO Disease: The Ego vs. The Organization

Patient Zero: Lee Iacocca



Diagnosis: Surrounded himself with worshippers, exiled critics.

Result: Kept releasing the same car models with superficial changes. Focused on his own image while competitors innovated.

The Antidote: Jack Welch



Strategy: Selected executives based on “runway” (capacity for growth), not just history.

Accountability: When a trader lost millions, he apologized to the team: “I blamed myself for the disaster.”

Mindsets in Love

The 'Ideal Mate' Checklist

Fixed Mindset Ideal Mate

- ☐ Put me on a pedestal.
- ☐ Make me feel perfect.
- ☐ Worship me.

Goal: Enshrine fixed qualities.

Growth Mindset Ideal Mate

- ☒ See my faults and help work on them.
- ☒ Challenge me to become a better person.
- ☒ Encourage me to learn new things.

Goal: Foster development.

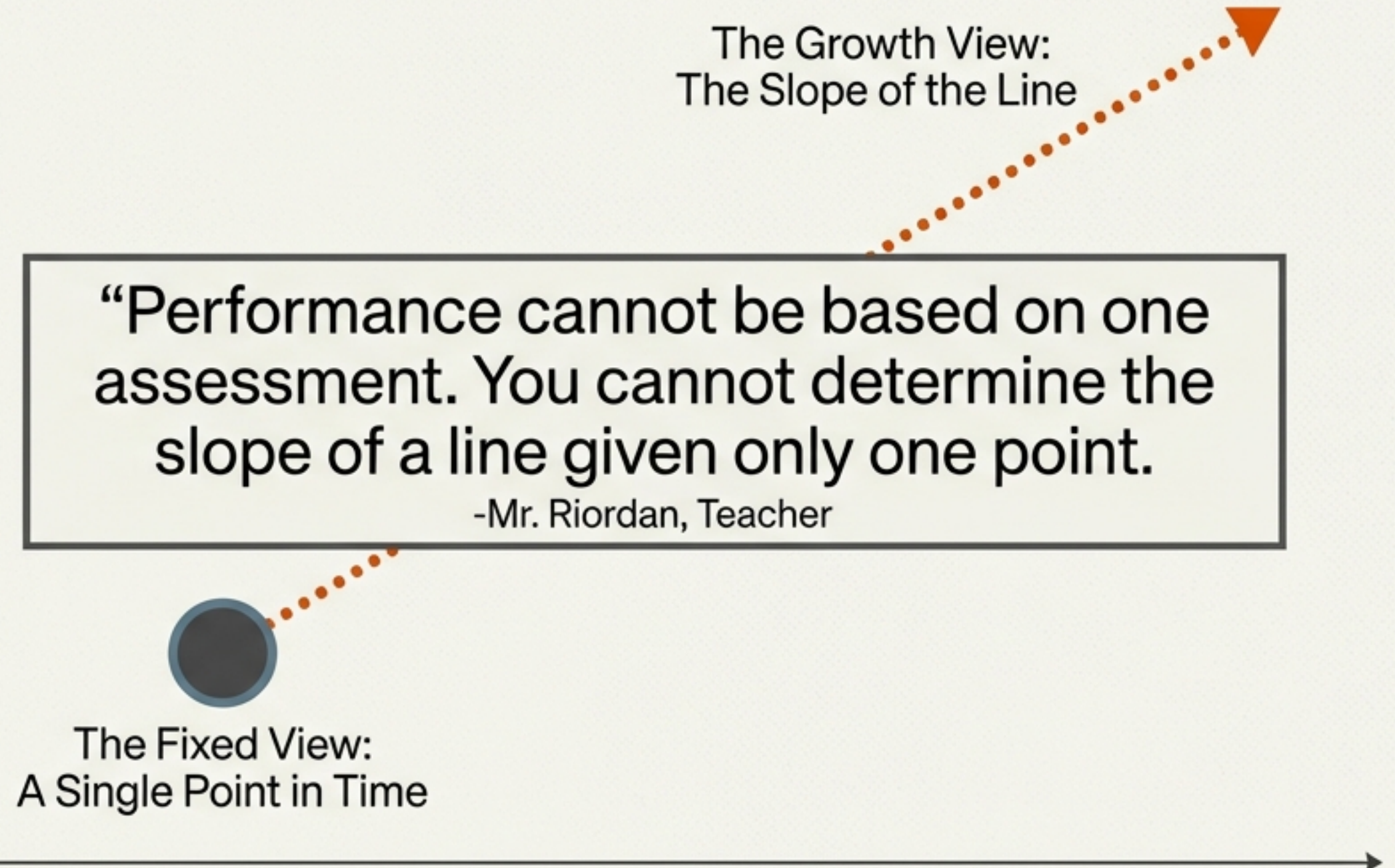
The Conflict: One person's growth (confronting problems) is the other person's nightmare (feeling judged).

The Trap of 'Potential'

The Story of the Eagles

Loretta's Journey

Loretta was placed in the "Eagles" (elite) kindergarten class. She stayed there until high school but never felt she belonged. She believed that first test diagnosed her fixed ability forever.



Coping with the “Winter Blues”

Study: Student diaries during high-stress months

Fixed Mindset Reaction



- Higher levels of depression led to LESS action.
- Ruminated on problems: "I'm a dope."
- Result: Stopped handing in assignments; let life slide.

Growth Mindset Reaction



- The more depressed they felt, the MORE determined they became.
- Action: "Every day I forced myself to get up, shower, shave."
- Result: Viewed mood as a problem to be solved, not an identity.

Editorial Psychology

“Special, Superior, Entitled”

The danger of the self-esteem movement.

The Trap: When success means you are “better” than others, failure means you are “worse”.

The Result: Entitlement rather than confidence.



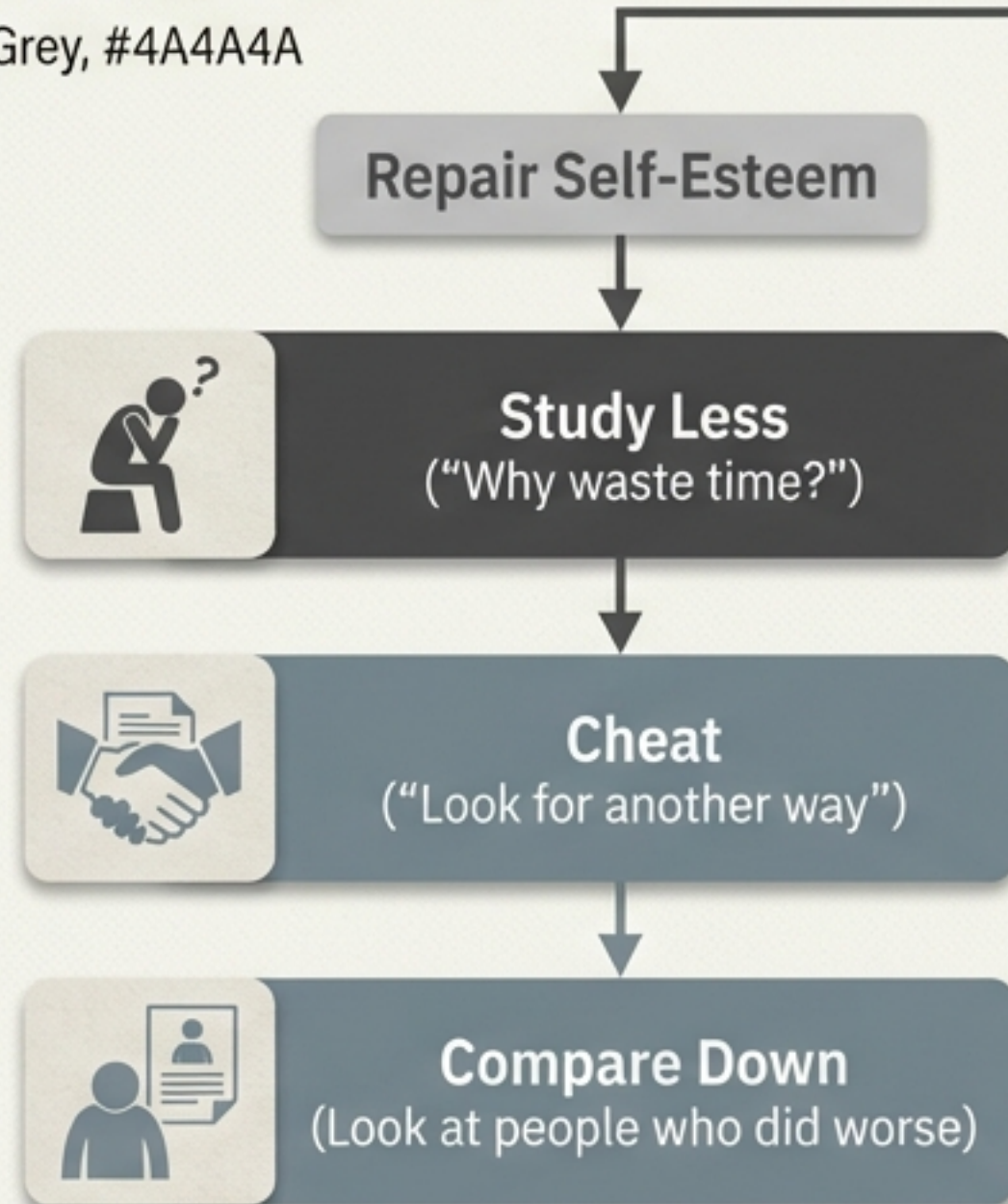
True Confidence:
Comes from the courage to be open—to welcome the journey of “becoming” rather than the state of “being”.

Shirk, Cheat, Blame

The Question: What do you do after a poor test grade?

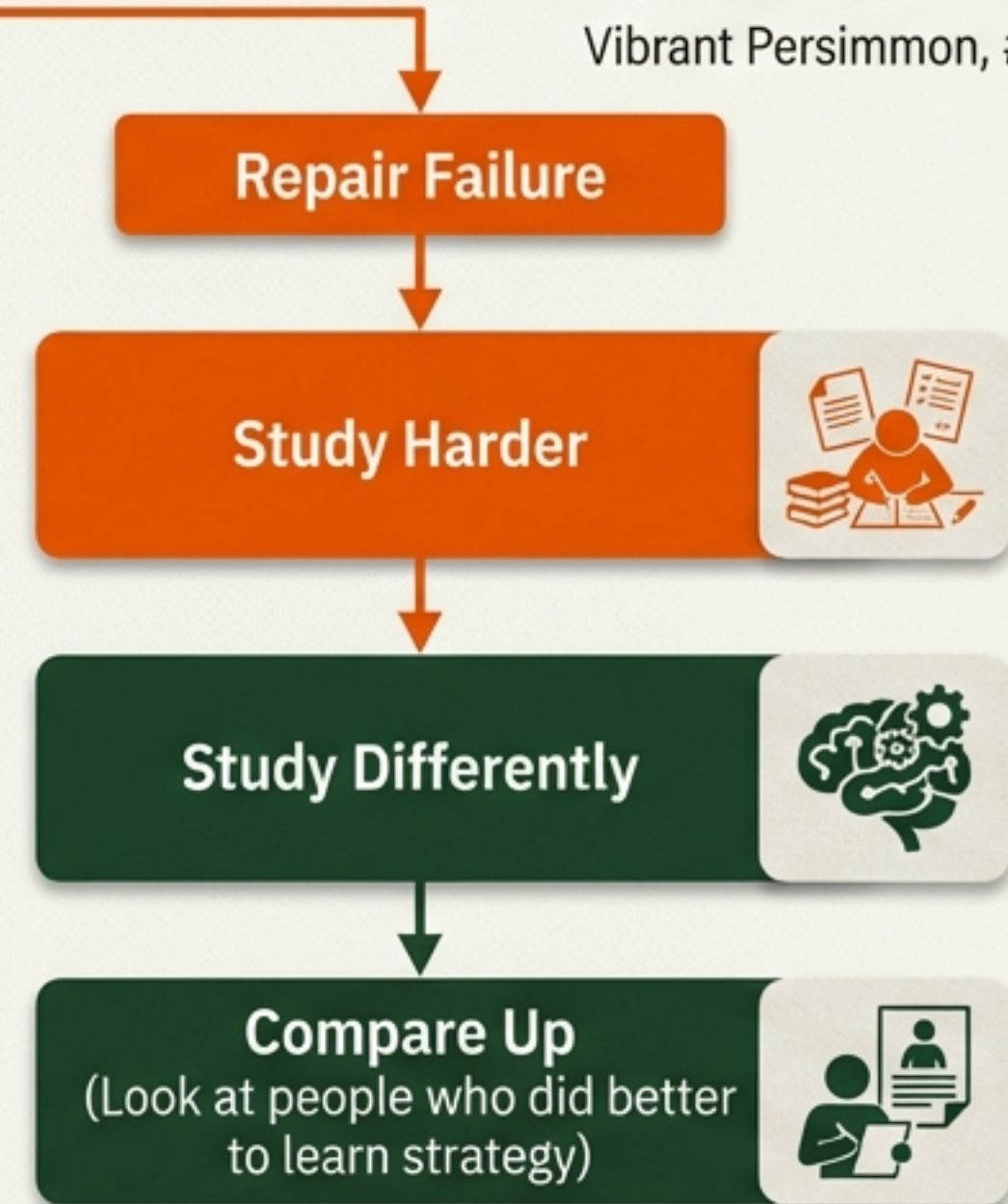
Fixed Mindset Reaction

Slate Grey, #4A4A4A



Growth Mindset Reaction

Vibrant Persimmon, #E65100



The Power of YET

I don't know
how to do this. ^ YET.

The Columbia Grad Student Dilemma: Brilliant students felt like impostors because they couldn't produce research instantly. They forgot they were there to LEARN.

The Shift: They knew how to take tests, but they didn't know how to do research... YET.

The Choice is Yours



The Transformation: The moment you catch yourself saying, “This is hard. This is fun.”—that is the moment you are changing your mindset.

“Mindsets are just beliefs. They’re powerful beliefs, but they’re just something in your mind, and you can change your mind.”